STATE OF WASHINGTON
DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL AND HEALTH SERVICES
COMMUNITY SERVICES DIVISION
Economic Services Administration
Post Office Box 45440 Olympia WA 98504-5440

Dec. 13, 2024

Dear interested parties and community partners,

We have great news. The Community Services Division is increasing the maximum Diversion Cash Assistance benefit from $1,250 to $2,000, effective Jan. 1, 2025. The costs of everyday living needs such as housing, transportation and employment-related expenses have grown significantly since the DCA program was created. The changes to RCW 74.08A.210 "*Diversion program – Emergency assistance*" increases the DCA maximum cash benefit to $2,000 to better meet a family's true expenses for one month.

DCA provides one month of assistance in a 12-month period to families that meet income and resource limits for the Temporary Assistance for Needy Families program but only need short-term help. To qualify for DCA, families must show how they will meet their basic living needs for the following 12 months. Families are often eligible for the program when they experience a gap in employment and have a new job offer or start working but have not yet received a paycheck. As an alternative to TANF, the DCA program assists families in meeting basic needs such as child care, housing, transportation and other expenses to get a job or stay employed. These payments are made directly to vendors whenever possible, with the actual payment continuing to be based on the family's needs.

This change helps families and aligns with DSHS' mission to partner with people to access support, care and resources. If you have any questions, please reach out to Melissa Kenney, TANF and WorkFirst program administrator, at Melissa.Kenney@dshs.wa.gov.

Thank you.

Sincerely,

Brice Montgomery, Interim Director
Community Services Division

DSHS: *Partnering with People*